

MOVIE

Frozen 2

★★★★☆ | It's the time of the year where we reminisce about the massive phenomenon that "Let It Go" from Frozen 1 was while belting out, seemingly, the new breakout single 'Into the Unknown' from the much-awaited sequel, Frozen 2. The film is a masterpiece in terms of visuals, voice acting and singing even though it hasn't managed to touch the lofty heights that the first film set in 2013 when it comes to the story and character arc. Nevertheless, children today, and those that were children back in 2013 (as well as a few adults) will be delighted by the spectacle that Frozen 2 is.

The film is a coming of age one, which centres around the two sisters, Elsa (Idina Menzel) and Anna (Kristen Bell) who are coming to grips with their



responsibilities and power, especially the former. Even 'Olaf', the anthropomorphised snowman, is attempting to deal with the unpredictabilities in life. While Olaf's character was largely criticised in Frozen 1 as annoying and over-the-top, the snowman absolutely won our hearts this time with his naivety, innocence and unwavering loyalty in the sequel. Elsa goes through a turbulent battle to find her identity and get answers to questions that plague her the most – the source of her powers

and the untimely death of her parents. The journey of her discovering her true self is an epic one, however, falls short when compared to the wholesomeness of her journey explored in the first film. Characters such as Kristoff (Jonathan Groff), Olaf and Sven are back in this sequel as well, and each one has some standout moments.

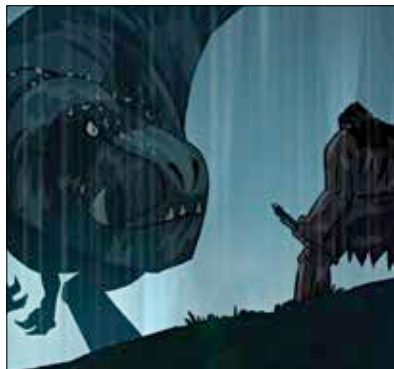
The film is an exuberant one that certainly warrants a theatrical visit. Frozen 2 is conventional in a lot of areas, but where it does break normality is by not having an actual antagonist. It breaks the mould of films having to have a prevailing, threatening antagonist to be a flamboyant and entertaining affair. Instead, it features tons of small threats. The second half of the film does slow down considerably in pace while picking up splendidly again during the climax. Overall, the film does justice to its prequel and will delight children (and adults with a childish streak) across the globe through its visuals, voice acting, and interesting storyline.

TV SHOW

Primal

★★★★★ | In the original Samurai Jack, Genndy Tartakovsky had to use robots as enemies as spilling blood was considered too graphic for an animated show aimed at kids. Adult Swim has allowed Tartakovsky to work with a new series free of such restrictions, and the results are glorious. The series has a prehistoric setting, when all the things that make a modern man were just emerging. There are also scientifically accurate dinosaurs, and a wide variety of other prehistoric creatures. There are absolutely no dialogues, and the result is a riveting action story that absolutely demands all your attention. This is not one of those shows where you can fiddle with your phone while "watching" the show.

Primal is a fantasy series where an early hominin and a T-Rex band together after both suffer from an attack by a



pack of Carnotaurus. The proportions of the hominin and the T-Rex are actually what you would expect, instead of the typically exaggerated proportions seen in many movies. The rest of the story follows the developing partnership between the man and the T-Rex, and how they grow closer together, saving each other's lives from all kinds of ridiculous situations. These include the hunting of Metridiochoerus, being attacked by Dromaeosaurus (which are unfortunately without feathers), being captured by giant bats, a surprise encounter with a Sarcosuchus (it will be a surprise even if

you are expecting it), and an underwater fight with a Titanoboa. During all these misadventures, the two are coming to terms with their grief and trauma. The backgrounds are detailed and stunning. The action sequences are gory, unrelenting and over the top. The series also has a heart though.

There are some mystical sequences involving woolly mammoths, ape-men and shamanic apes that explores how all creatures, not just humans, understand the relationships that they have with their environments. There is plenty of room for interpretation considering there is no explanation provided for some of the things shown on screen. The presentation is "as is", take from it what you want. Primal has received nearly universal acclaim from both reviewers and viewers, and is easily among the best animated series ever created. There are five episodes out now, and another five scheduled for release next year. Once you have seen the series, it is also worth checking out the pitch animatics on the Adult Swim website.